once did he raise the question of Purshotamdas joining politics or the Congress party. He recognized his independence and admired him for his rectitude. Purshotamdas for his part held Gandhi in high esteem for his honesty and while both differed on many questions, these differences never affected the mutual admiration they had for one another. In fact Purshotamdas had been critical of the launching of the Civil Disobedience movement in 1930. He had written to Gandhi asking him to respond to the Viceroy's gesture in calling a Round Table Conference long before the Simon Commission's report, and inviting those who had boycotted it to a conference with the Cabinet. Purshotamdas said that to resort to civil disobedience in the interval struck him as being a hasty and risky step which was not conducive to India's interests. Gandhi's reply was curt: 'I must not enter into argument with you for argument is useless when conviction on either side is deep seated. I can only give you my assurance that I shall take no hasty step. A risky step need not necessarily be a hasty step.'[4]

But Gandhi's high regard for Purshotamdas was evident when he asked him to intercede on his behalf to make Pt Madan Mohan Malaviya change his position on caste representations in order to accommodate the minorities. Gandhi was a member of the Federal Structure Sub-committee and the Minorities Sub-committee—the two main Sub-committees through which the work of the Round Table Conference was being carried out. Purshotamdas was a member of the Federal Structure Sub-committee and G.D. Birla a member of the Minorities Sub-committee. Gandhi's idea was to hammer out a solution ratified by the Hindus, Muslims, and other minorities so as to render British intervention superfluous. When Purshotamdas conveyed Gandhi's message to Pt Malaviya he refused to relent. He said that he was willing to accept the arbitration of the British Prime Minister. This suggestion shocked Purshotamdas as he was dismayed at handing over to the British government a task which they themselves could successfully undertake. Gandhi received an offer from the Aga Khan to join hands but was unwilling to do so unless he could get Malaviya to concur. The impasse could not be resolved and what followed was the government's Communal Award of August 1932 which deepened communal fissures and culminated in the partition of the country fifteen years later.